

07

QUALITY CONTROL

# Publishing Checklist

Check every post before it goes out — and learn from every post after it does.

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**3**

CHECKLISTS

**1**

WEEKLY REVIEW

**5 min**

PER POST

[START HERE](#)

# How to use this checklist

Good content is often let down by small things: a typo in the first line, a missing call to action, a cropped graphic. Two minutes with this checklist catches them.

## Three checklists, three moments

### EVERY POST

#### Before publishing

A final quality check on every post. Takes 2–3 minutes once it becomes a habit.

### EVERY POST

#### After publishing

What to do in the hours and days after a post goes live.

### ONCE A WEEK

#### Weekly review

A 20-minute routine to learn what's working and plan what's next.

## Ways to use it

- **Print it** and keep it next to your desk.
- **Copy the checklists** into your notes app or project tool as a reusable template.
- **Pin the “Before publishing” list** next to your scheduling tool so you see it every time.

### REMEMBER

You don't need to be perfect. If a post passes the “Before publishing” checklist, it's ready — publish it and move on.

## EVERY POST

# Before publishing

Work from top to bottom. If you can't tick an item, fix it before you post.

## Message

- ☐ **Strong hook**  
The first line, slide or two seconds gives a clear reason to keep reading or watching.
- ☐ **Clear message**  
The post makes one main point that you could summarize in one sentence.
- ☐ **Target audience identified**  
You know exactly who this is for, and the wording speaks to them.

## Visual & caption

- ☐ **Visual reviewed**  
Text is readable on a phone, nothing important is cropped and the design is consistent.
- ☐ **Caption reviewed**  
It adds context, sounds like you and uses line breaks for easy reading.
- ☐ **CTA included**  
One clear next step that matches the goal of the post.

## Accuracy & brand

- ☐ **Spelling checked**  
Read it once more, slowly — or out loud. Check names and handles especially.
- ☐ **Facts checked**  
Every number, claim and recommendation verified, particularly anything AI generated.
- ☐ **Brand consistency checked**  
Your colors, fonts, tone of voice and topics match the rest of your content.

## EVERY POST

# Final technical checks

Quick checks that prevent the most common avoidable problems.

- ☐ **Correct size and format**  
Portrait 4:5 for feed posts, 9:16 for Stories, Reels and TikTok. See the reference table below.
- ☐ **Text inside the safe area**  
On vertical video, keep important text away from the top and bottom edges, where buttons and captions appear.
- ☐ **Alt text added where available**  
A short description of the image helps people using screen readers.
- ☐ **Links tested**  
Any link in your bio, Story or caption opens the right page.
- ☐ **Tags and mentions correct**  
You have permission to feature anyone you tag, show or quote.
- ☐ **Keywords and hashtags relevant**  
A few specific, relevant terms — not a long list of unrelated ones.
- ☐ **Posting time decided**  
Scheduled or posted at a time when you can reply to early comments.

## Common format reference

| PLATFORM / FORMAT              | RECOMMENDED SIZE              | RATIO      |
|--------------------------------|-------------------------------|------------|
| Instagram feed post (portrait) | 1080 × 1350 px                | 4:5        |
| Instagram square post          | 1080 × 1080 px                | 1:1        |
| Instagram Stories & Reels      | 1080 × 1920 px                | 9:16       |
| TikTok & YouTube Shorts        | 1080 × 1920 px                | 9:16       |
| LinkedIn image post            | 1080 × 1080 or 1080 × 1350 px | 1:1 or 4:5 |
| YouTube thumbnail              | 1280 × 720 px                 | 16:9       |

Platforms update their specifications from time to time. If something looks cropped after uploading, check the platform's current guidance.

## EVERY POST

# After publishing

Publishing is the middle of the process, not the end. What you do next helps you build relationships and better content.

- ☐ **Reply to comments**  
Answer thoughtfully, especially in the first few hours. Ask a follow-up question where it feels natural.
- ☐ **Save useful feedback**  
Copy questions, objections and kind words into a note. They're future content ideas and testimonials.
- ☐ **Review engagement**  
After 2–3 days, note saves, shares, comments and profile visits — not just likes.
- ☐ **Identify what worked**  
Was it the topic, the hook, the format or the timing? Write one sentence about why.
- ☐ **Repurpose strong content**  
Add your best posts to a "repurpose" list and give them a second life in a new format.

## Signals worth paying attention to

| SIGNAL                   | WHAT IT USUALLY TELLS YOU                                          |
|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Saves                    | The content is useful enough to come back to.                      |
| Shares and sends         | People think it will help or speak to someone they know.           |
| Comments                 | The topic started a conversation or touched a nerve.               |
| Profile visits & follows | The post made people curious about you.                            |
| Link clicks & messages   | Interest in going further — your offer, your guide, your services. |

**KEEP PERSPECTIVE**

Compare your posts with each other, not with other accounts. Your own trends over a few weeks are far more useful than any single number.

ONCE A WEEK

# Weekly review checklist

Set aside 20 minutes at the end of each week. This is where the real improvement happens.

- ☐ **List everything you published this week**  
Use the worksheet on the next page.

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- ☐ **Find your top post**  
The one with the most saves, shares or meaningful comments.

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- ☐ **Find your weakest post**  
Look for a reason, not a judgment: topic, hook, format or timing?

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- ☐ **Note recurring questions**  
What did people ask more than once? That's next week's content.

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- ☐ **Check your pillar balance**  
Mostly value, some personal, occasional promotion?

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- ☐ **Pick one post to repurpose**  
Plan its new format using File 10.

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- ☐ **Plan next week's posts**  
Check your calendar and swap any ideas that no longer fit.

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- ☐ **Batch-create your first posts**  
Draft at least two posts now, while ideas are fresh.

## WORKSHEET

# Weekly review worksheet

Print a copy each week, or recreate it in a spreadsheet.

Week of: \_\_\_\_\_

| DAY | POST / TOPIC | FORMAT | PILLAR | SAVES | SHARES | COMMENTS |
|-----|--------------|--------|--------|-------|--------|----------|
|     |              |        |        |       |        |          |
|     |              |        |        |       |        |          |
|     |              |        |        |       |        |          |
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|     |              |        |        |       |        |          |

What worked best this week, and why?

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What will I do differently next week?

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Which post will I repurpose, and into what format?

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Questions from my audience to answer next week:

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